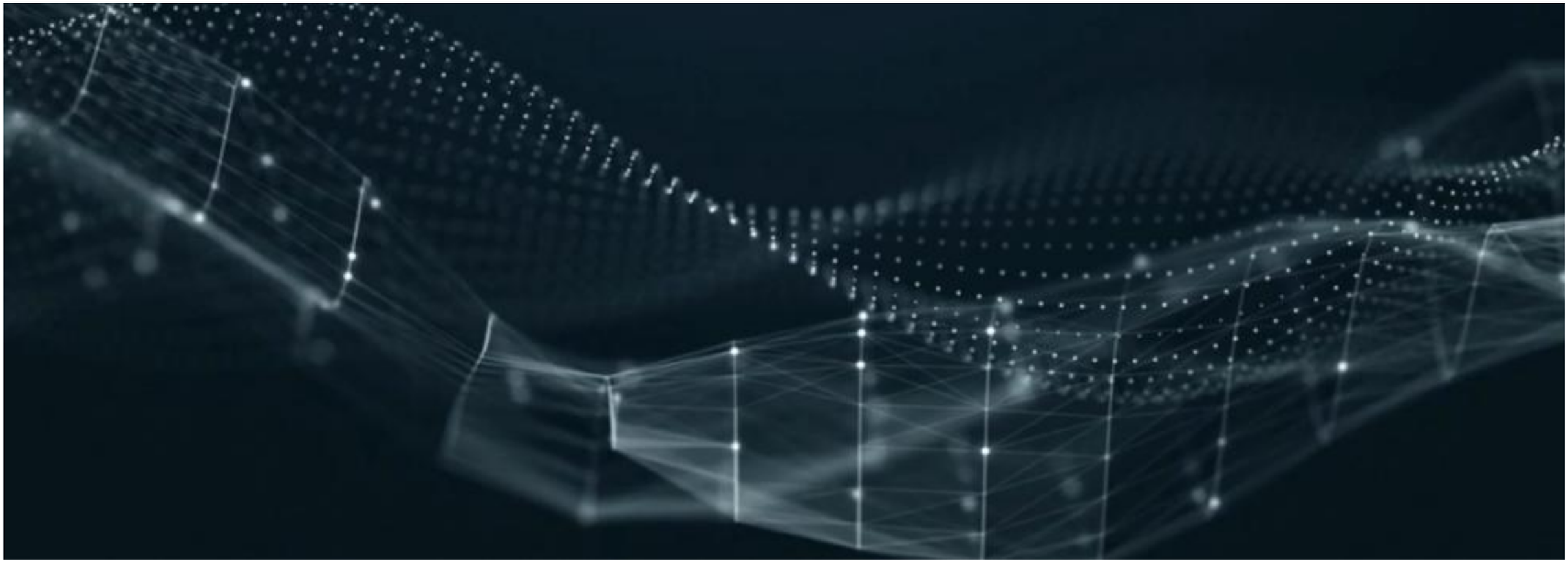
Power

North America Outlook | Week of 23 February 2026

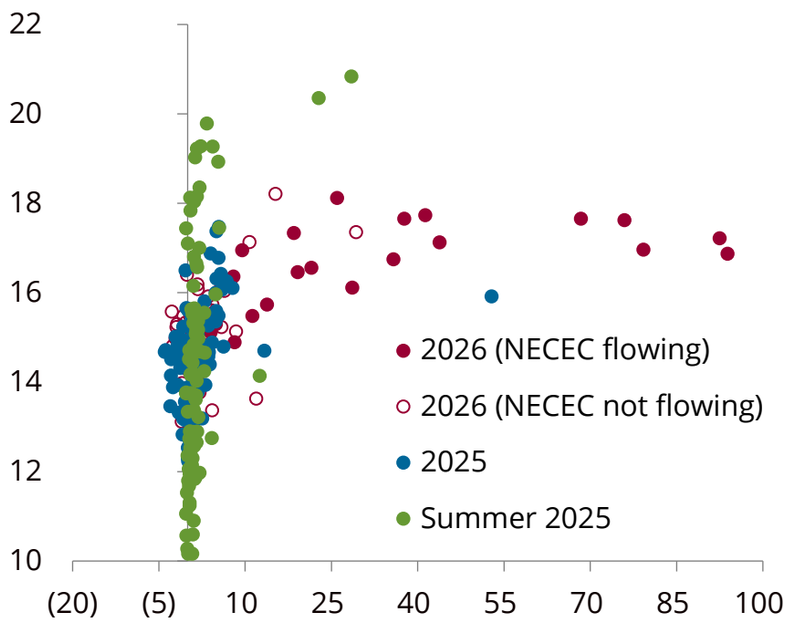
Power and natural gas weekly update



NECEC-driven Mass–Maine price dislocation to continue this summer

Winter Mass–Maine RT spread vs ISONE ATC load

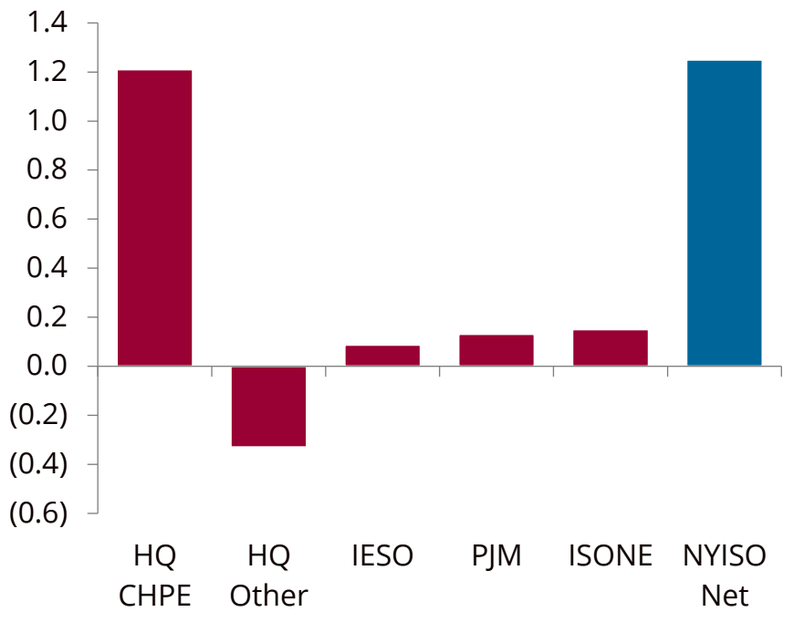
GW (y-axis); $/MWh (x-axis)



Mass–Maine price dislocation will persist this summer at high loads as NECEC, Maine renewables and New Brunswick flows suppress Maine zone LMPs.

NYISO June–August net trade, y/y

GW



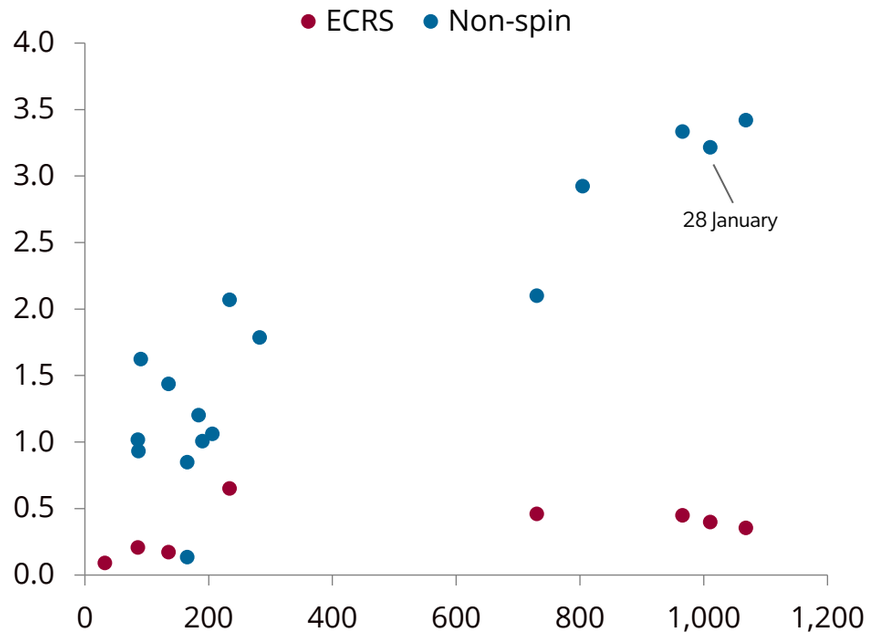
NYISO will be 1.2 GW net longer y/y this summer but largely in zones east of the Central-East constraint through Zone J. Western NYISO zones could tighten due to HQ exports.

Note: Winter is December–February; NECEC flow days = imports exceed 100 MW for more than 50% of hours
Source: Pharos, ICE, ISONE, Energy Aspects

Gas prices and battery SOC led ERCOT price formation rather than reserve shortages

ERCOT ancillary reserve deployment vs system-wide price

GW (y-axis), $/MWh (x-axis)



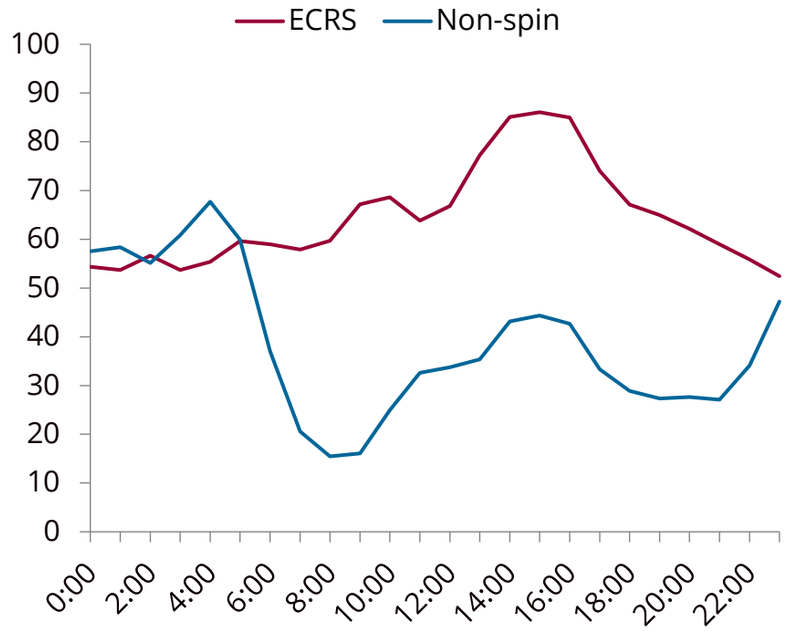
While ERCOT procured 1.2 GW more reserves y/y this winter, nearly 4 GW shifted from ancillaries to energy at high power prices. Non-spin led deployments, as it is cheapest to dispatch.

Note: Ancillary shortage data points are 15-minute intervals

Source: ERCOT, Energy Aspects

Winter share of ancillary service plan awarded to batteries

%



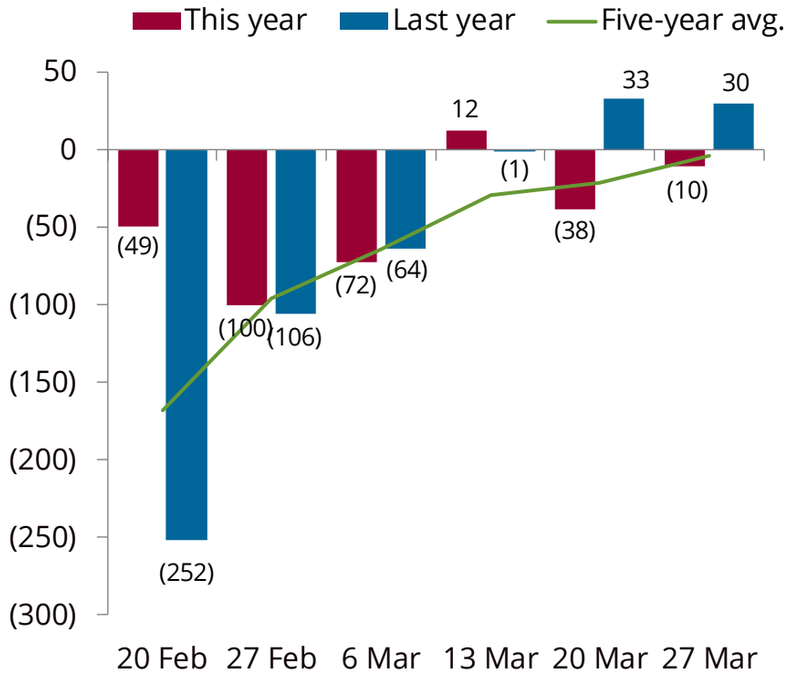
ERCOT confirmed it deployed up to 1.6 GW of generators through reliability unit commitments. Low battery state of charge had participation in non-spin fall to 0% in some intervals.

Note: Ancillary shortage data points are 15-minute intervals

Lower 48 storage forecast

EIA weekly storage activity

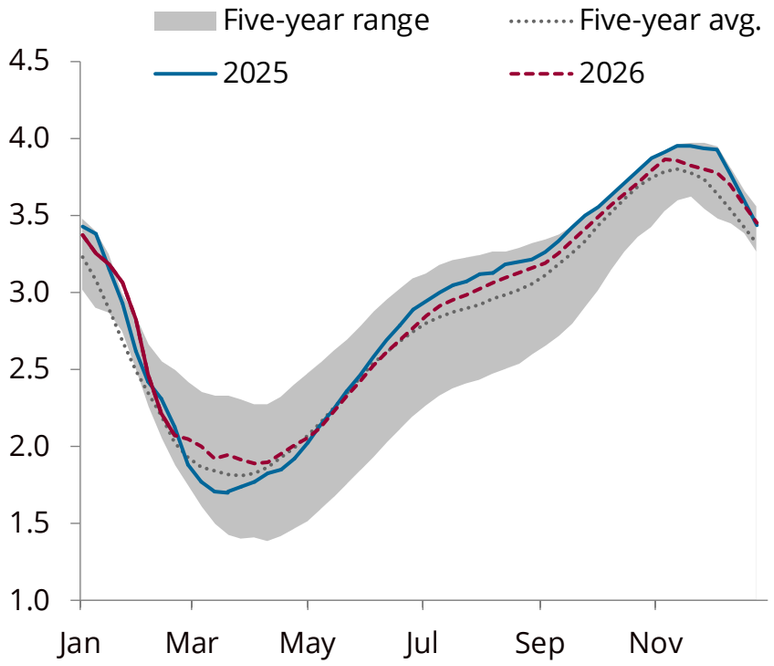
bcf



We estimate a 49 bcf withdrawal for Thursday's EIA report, as moderating temperatures led HDDs to realise 19% below 10-year normal with res-com demand loosening balances.

US gas storage

tcf



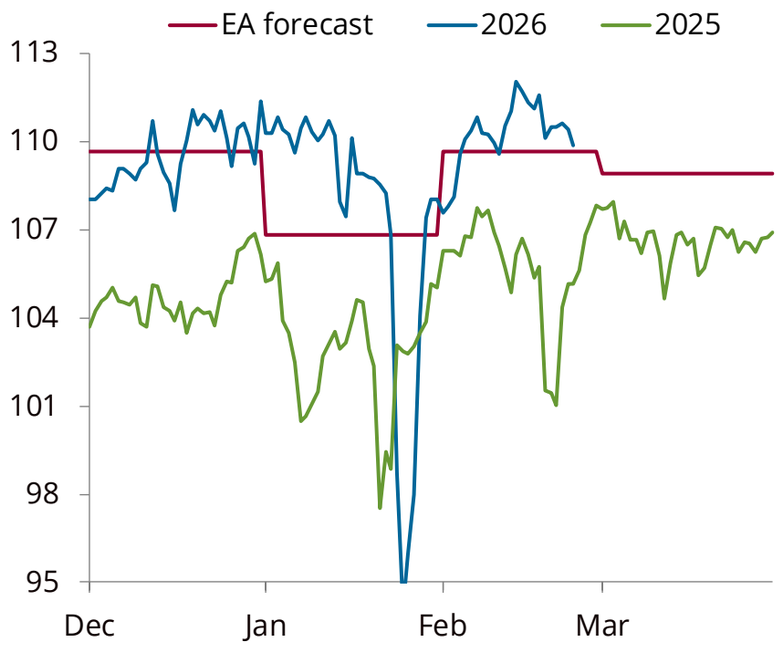
Our end-March storage estimate loosened by 138 bcf w/w to 1.78 tcf, as mild weather expectations in the two-week forecast persistently loosen balances.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

Domestic gas production

Total dry gas production

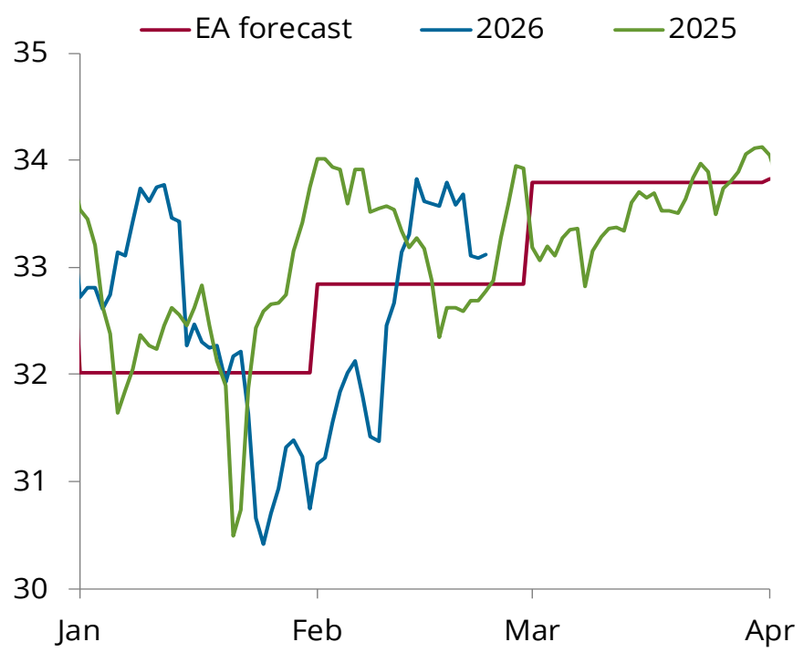
bcf/d



Lower 48 production declined by 1.00 bcf/d w/w to average 110.14 bcf/d WTD on Northeast cold restricting Appalachia volumes over the weekend.

Appalachian gas production

bcf/d



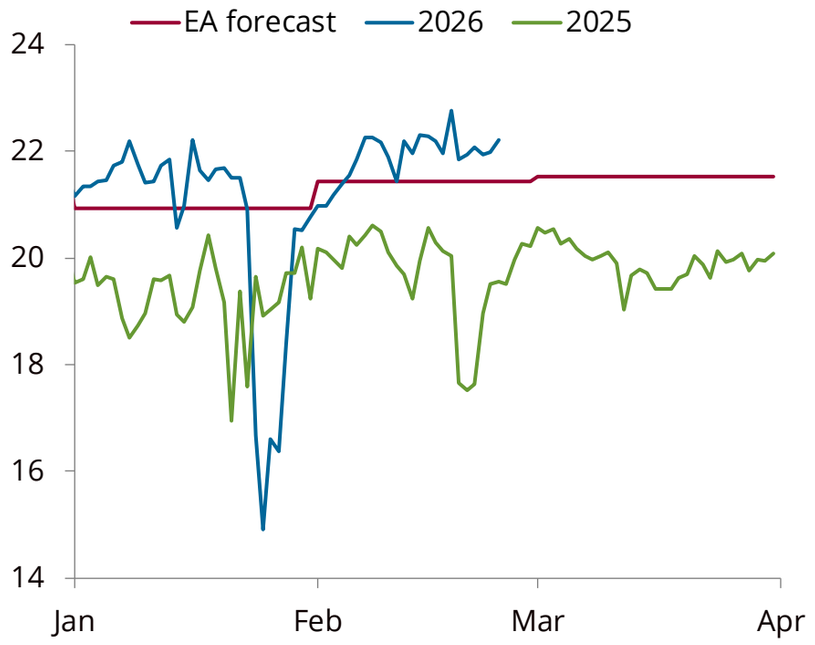
Appalachia flows average 32.83 bcf/d WTD, 0.80 bcf/d lower w/w on the Northeast blizzard limiting NEPA volumes. We expect flows to have a near-term resurgence.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Domestic gas production – Permian and Haynesville

Permian gas production

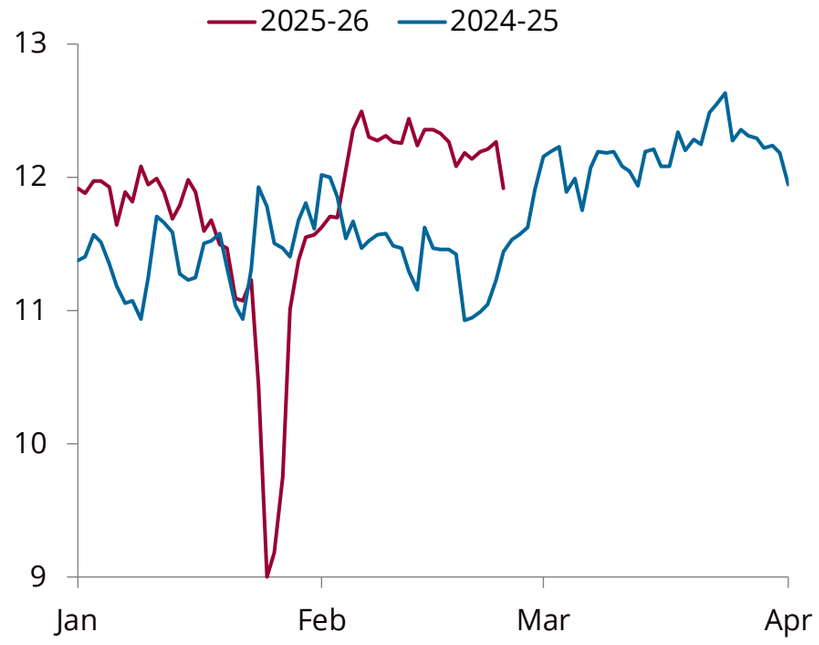
bcf/d



Permian production averages 22.1 bcf/d WTD, 0.1 bcf/d higher w/w with near-term Permian takeaway capacity diminished by GCX expansion start-up deferred to Q3 26.

Haynesville gas production

bcf/d



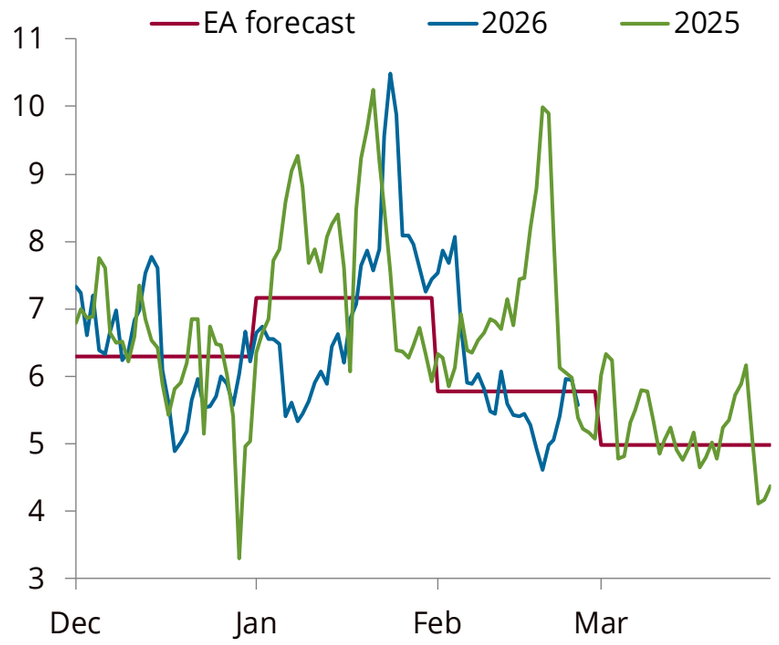
Our sample Haynesville flows remain volatile, declining by 0.3 bcf/d w/w to average 12.0 bcf/d WTD. We expect Q2 26 regional production to reach 13.0 bcf/d (+0.7 bcf/d y/y).

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Trade – Canada and Mexico

US imports from Canada

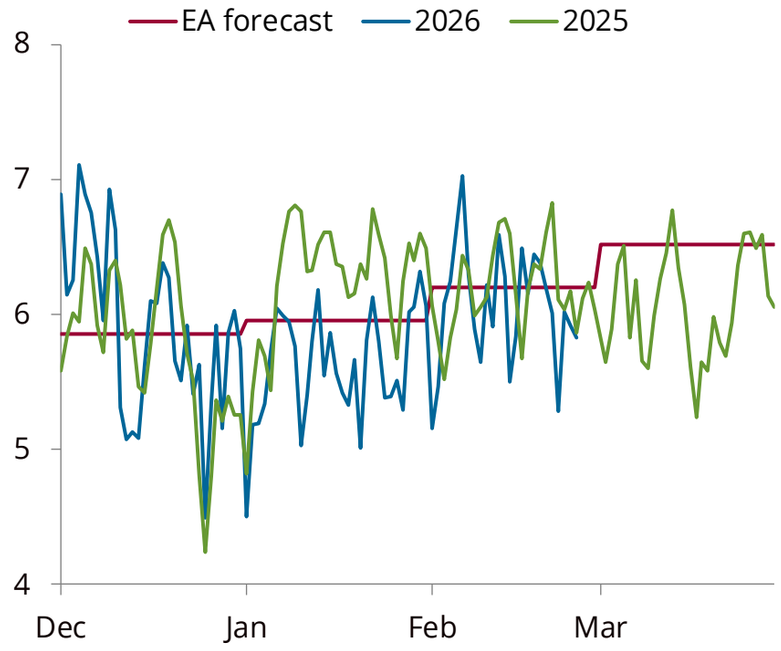
bcf/d



Net Canada trade averages 5.7 bcf/d WTD, 0.6 bcf/d higher w/w driven by colder weather and the lifting of capacity constraints past Emerson.

US exports to Mexico

bcf/d



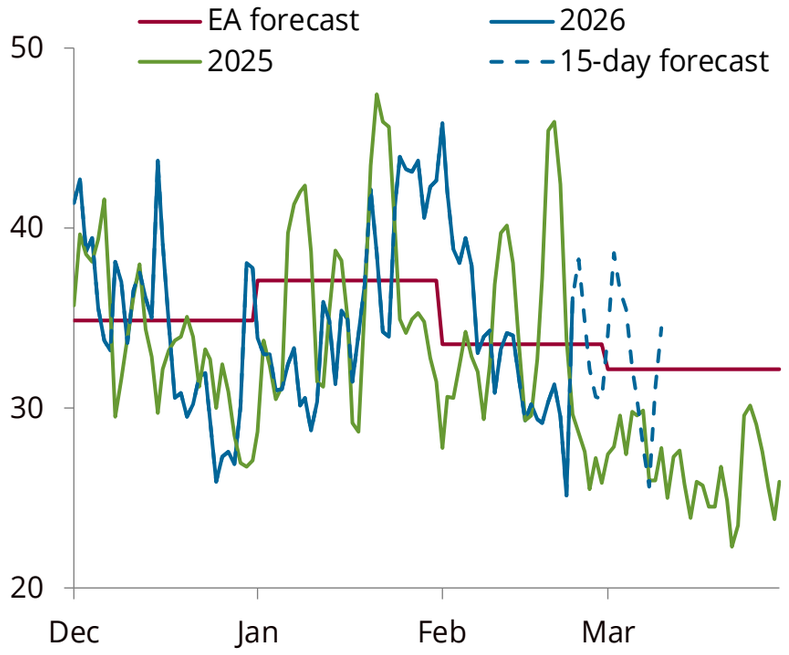
US exports to Mexico declined by 0.7 bcf/d w/w to average 5.5 bcf/d WTD on lower offshore gulf trade.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Gas demand – Power and res-com

Power gas demand

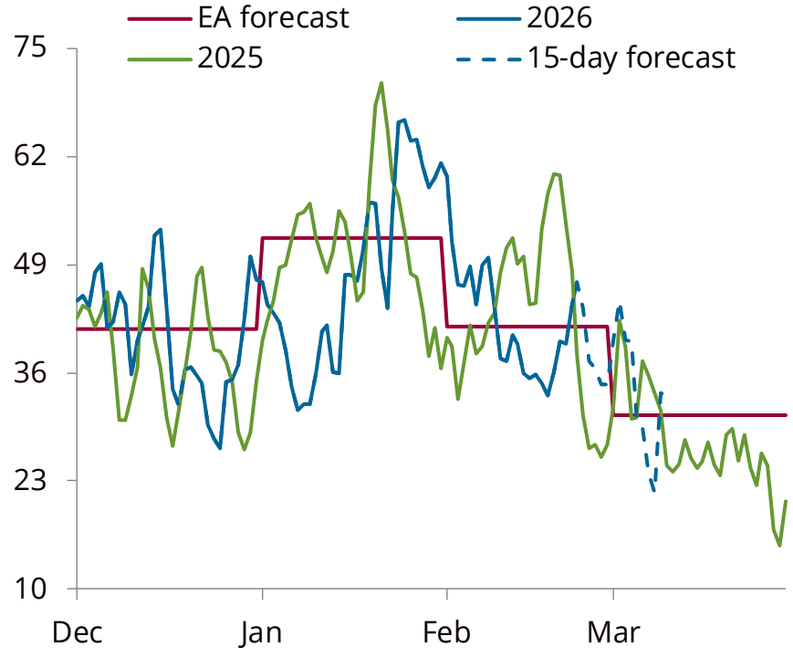
bcf/d



Our model estimates gas burns for the week ending 27 February will average 33.6 bcf/d, 2.7 bcf/d higher w/w with 68% gas share of thermal generation (-2 ppts w/w).

Res-com demand

bcf/d



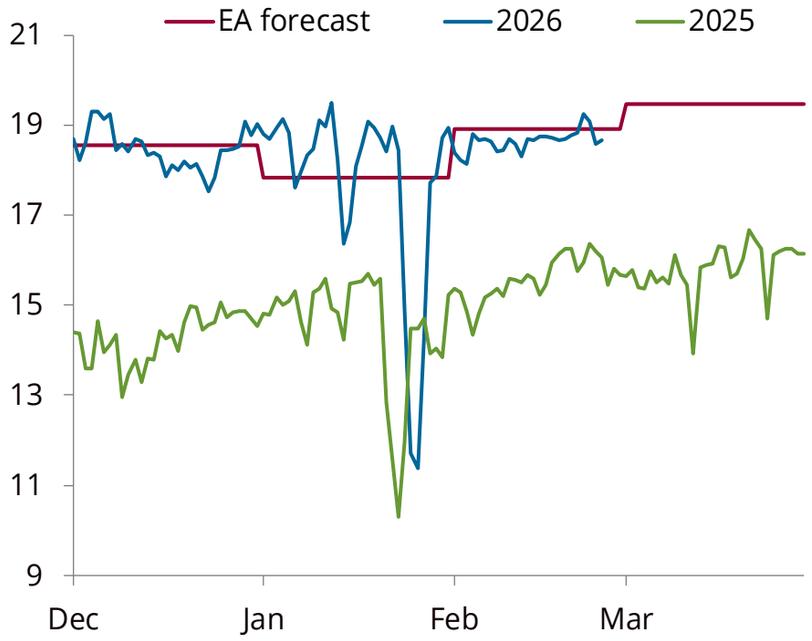
The recent Northeast blizzard increases (5.4 bcf/d w/w) our res-com demand estimate for the week ending 27 February, averaging 40.7 bcf/d.

Source: Spire Weather, Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Gas demand – LNG feedgas

LNG feedgas demand

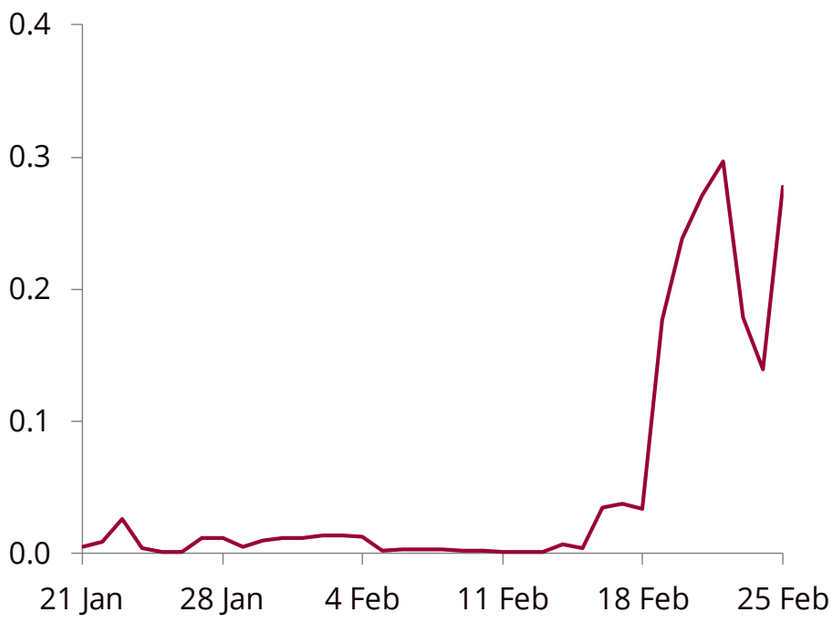
bcf/d



Visible LNG feedgas demand averages 19.0 bcf/d WTD, 0.3 bcf/d higher w/w, lifted by Golden Pass pipeline that signal imminent first LNG production.

Golden Pass feedgas demand

bcf/d



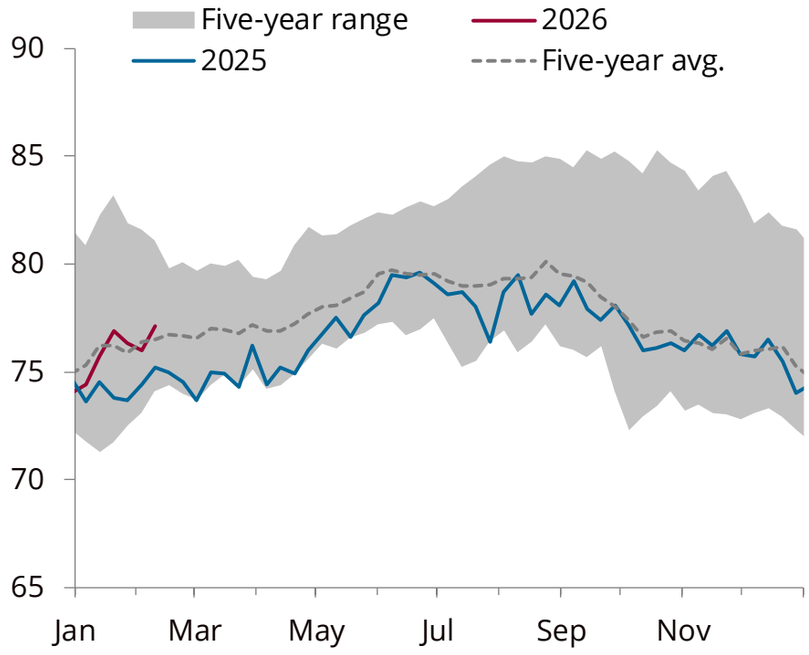
Golden Pass pipeline flows reached 0.27 bcf/d today, 0.14 bcf/d higher d/d. On 24 February, a FERC request to introduce gas to the cold end string was filed.

Source: Ventyx, Energy Aspects

Industrial demand sectors – Steel and refining

US steel capacity utilisation

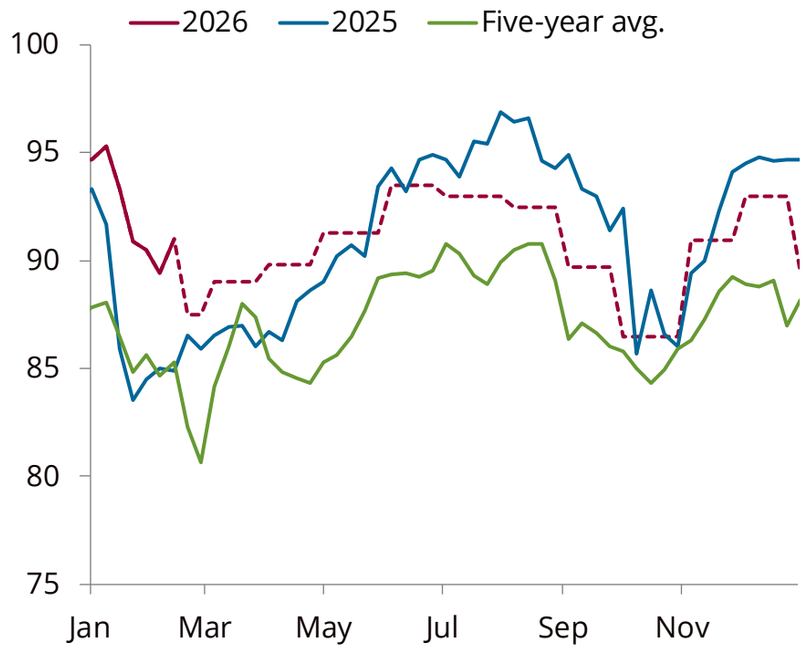
%



Steel capacity utilisation is at a five-month high of 77.8%. A ramp-up in Nucor's facilities that started in Q4 25 is likely an underlying cause.

US refinery capacity utilisation

%



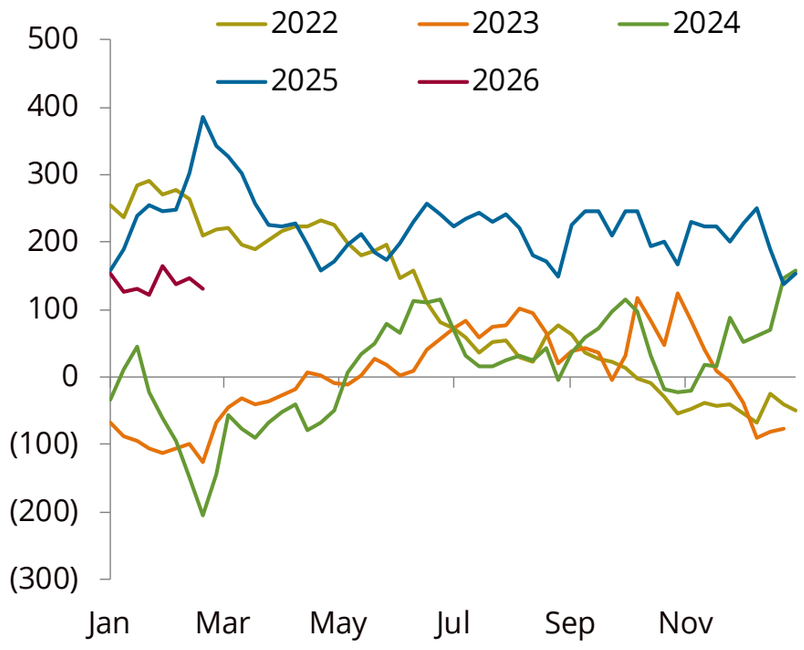
Refinery utilisation rose by 1.6 ppts w/w to 91% utilisation on strong runs YTD due to low unplanned maintenance.

Source: AISI, EIA, Energy Aspects

CFTC and rig counts

ICE, NYMEX net positioning

k lots



CFTC net positioning fell by 14.9k lots w/w and now stand at 132.0k lots net long.

Rig counts for select US basins

rigs

	Gas		Oil		Total	
20 Feb 26	133		409		551	
w/w chg.	*0*	-	*0*	-	*0*	-
y/y chg.	*31*	↑	*(77)*	↓	*(42)*	↓
13 Feb 26	133		409		551	
28 Feb 25	102		486		593	

	Appalachia		Haynesville		Permian	
20 Feb 26	40		52		239	
w/w chg.	*0*	-	*0*	-	*1*	↑
y/y chg.	*5*	↑	*21*	↑	*(66)*	↓
13 Feb 26	40		52		238	
28 Feb 25	35		31		305	

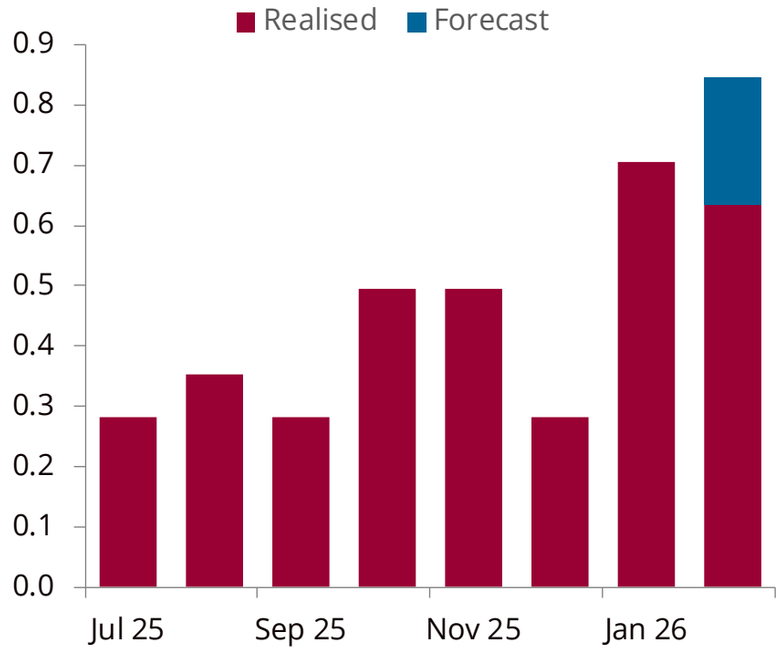
North American oil and gas rig counts were net unchanged w/w.

Source: Baker Hughes, Bloomberg, CFTC, ICE, Energy Aspects

LNG Canada ramp accelerates, driving higher forecast revision

LNG Canada cargoes

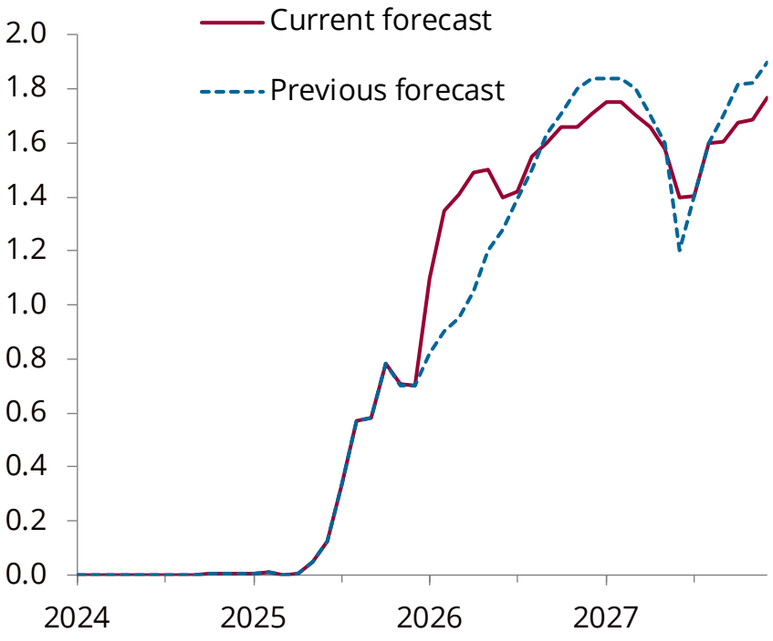
Mt



LNG Canada utilisation has skyrocketed since returning from outage in January. It is on pace to produce 0.85 Mt of LNG this month, roughly equal to 1.6 bcf/d at 71% utilisation.

LNG Canada feedgas forecast

bcf/d



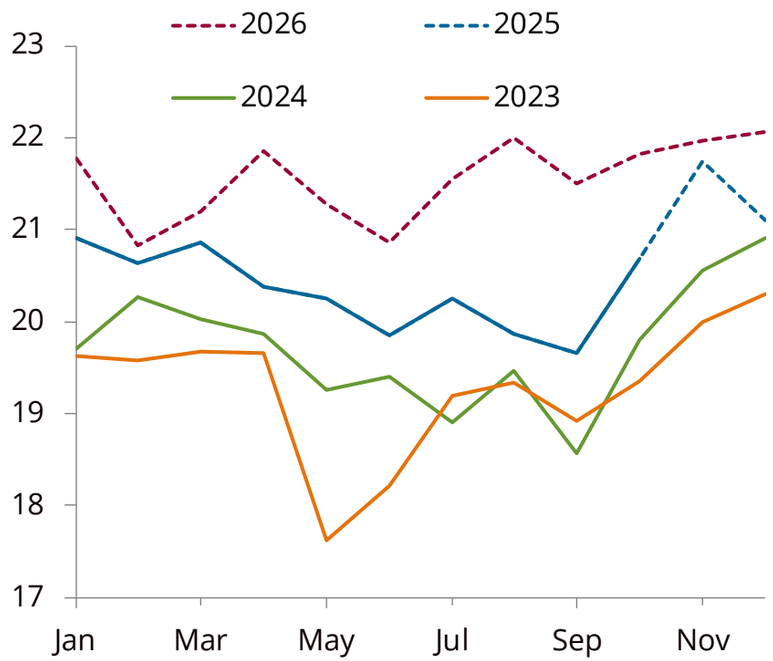
We have raised our LNG Canada feedgas forecast to 1.49 bcf/d, 0.15 bcf/d higher than our previous forecast, with further risk to the upside.

Source: LNG Cargo Tracking, StatCan, Energy Aspects

WCSB production to keep storage deficit close

WCBS production forecast

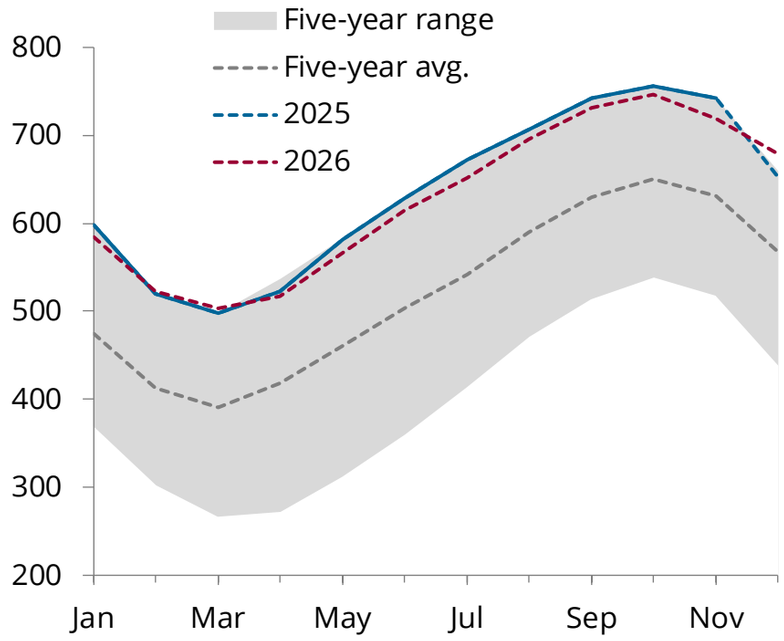
bcf/d



WCSB production will average 21.6 bcf/d, 1.0 bcf/d higher y/y. Some producers have already released guidance targeting 10% growth y/y.

Western Canada storage

bcf



LNG Canada will tighten balances y/y, but aggressive growth targets from WCSB producers will keep the Western end-October carryout just 10 bcf lower y/y.

Source: LNG Cargo Tracking, StatCan, Energy Aspects

Weather-normalised and peak-load growth

Weather-normalised load growth, y/y

%

	ISONE	NYISO	PJM	ERCOT	MISO	CAISO	SPP	US48
2027	0.6	0.9	3.2	5.7	1.0	0.6	1.5	3.5
2026	0.4	1.2	2.9	5.3	1.0	0.7	1.9	2.7
2025	(0.1)	0.1	2.4	5.9	2.2	(0.3)	3.7	2.5
Aug 26	0.2	1.0	2.6	4.6	1.0	0.6	1.5	2.9
Jul 26	(0.2)	1.0	3.2	4.7	1.1	0.7	1.9	3.0
Jun 26	0.4	1.7	3.1	5.1	1.4	0.8	2.0	3.1
May 26	(0.8)	0.6	2.8	5.7	0.5	0.6	1.6	2.6
Apr 26	0.7	1.4	3.0	6.7	0.8	0.0	1.8	3.1
Mar 26	0.0	1.5	3.2	6.8	1.2	1.2	1.9	3.5
Feb 26	1.4	1.2	2.6	3.9	1.5	0.2	1.4	1.7
Jan 26	2.5	1.1	1.5	2.4	0.4	1.1	2.4	(0.2)
Dec 25	0.4	(0.5)	1.7	3.7	1.8	0.6	5.0	1.4
Nov 25	(0.5)	(0.2)	2.9	4.2	(0.1)	(2.3)	4.8	1.5
Oct 25	(0.2)	(0.7)	3.7	5.7	1.6	0.0	3.1	2.9
Sep 25	(1.2)	(2.2)	3.8	7.3	4.2	0.1	3.4	2.8

Peak load, peak-load growth, y/y

%, GW

Season	Year	ISONE	NYISO	PJM	ERCOT	MISO	CAISO	US48
Summer (%)	**2027**	1.1	(0.9)	2.5	3.0	1.6	0.9	2.6
	2026	2.7	1.6	5.1	3.7	4.0	0.5	3.1
	2025	1.3	(2.4)	1.9	4.4	1.2	(0.0)	1.8
Winter (%)	**2027**	0.7	1.3	5.0	5.1	2.5	1.8	4.7
	2026	2.0	1.2	1.5	0.5	0.6	0.1	0.1
	2025	0.6	0.8	1.0	3.2	1.4	(1.3)	0.5
Summer (GW)	**2027**	25.7	31.3	170.1	96.4	128.5	48.5	793.5
	2026	25.4	31.6	165.9	93.6	126.5	48.0	773.2
	2025	24.8	31.1	157.8	90.2	121.6	47.8	750.1
Winter (GW)	**2027**	21.0	25.7	152.9	85.0	107.7	32.1	710.9
	2026	20.9	25.4	145.6	80.8	105.0	31.5	679.1
	2025	20.5	25.1	143.4	80.4	104.4	31.5	678.1

Our weather-normalised load model is likely understating PJM gains y/y in January and February, as historic cold weather complicates the load disaggregation.

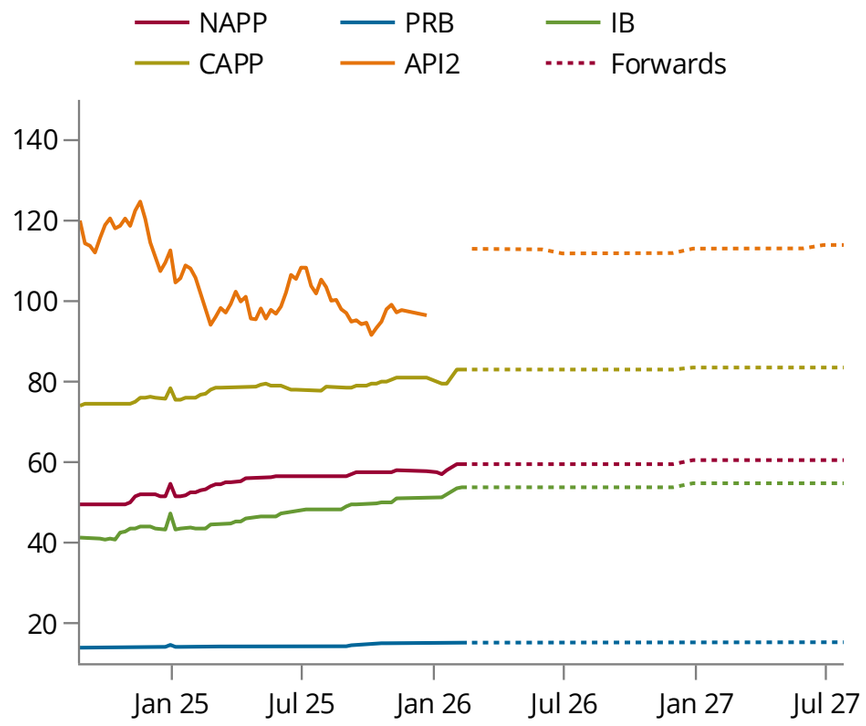
We expect winter peak load will grow faster than summer peak load in PJM due to heating electrification and behind-the-meter solar generation.

Source: ISOs, Energy Aspects

Coal prices and production

Coal prices

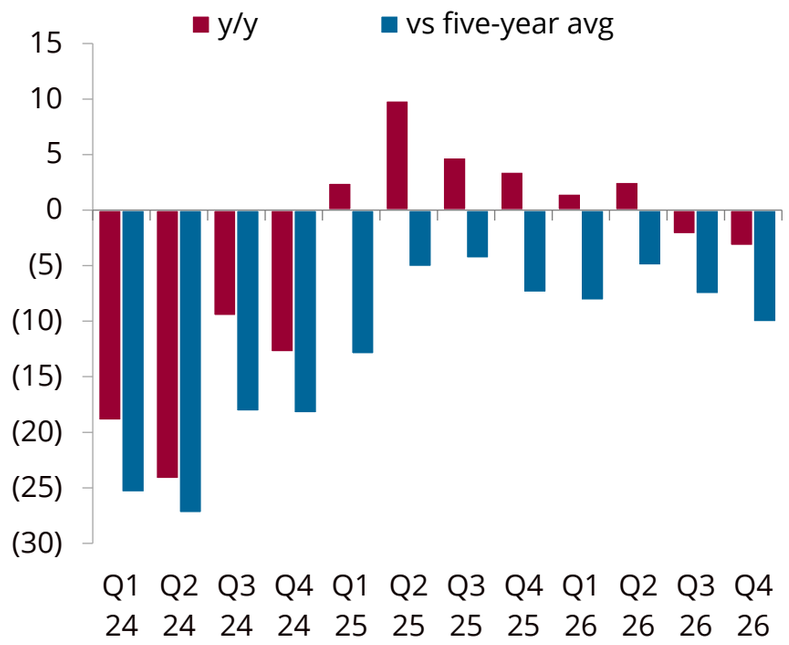
$/t



Physical coal prices have risen w/w due to export market dynamics that are potentially raising the call on US tonnage.

Lower 48 coal production

Mt



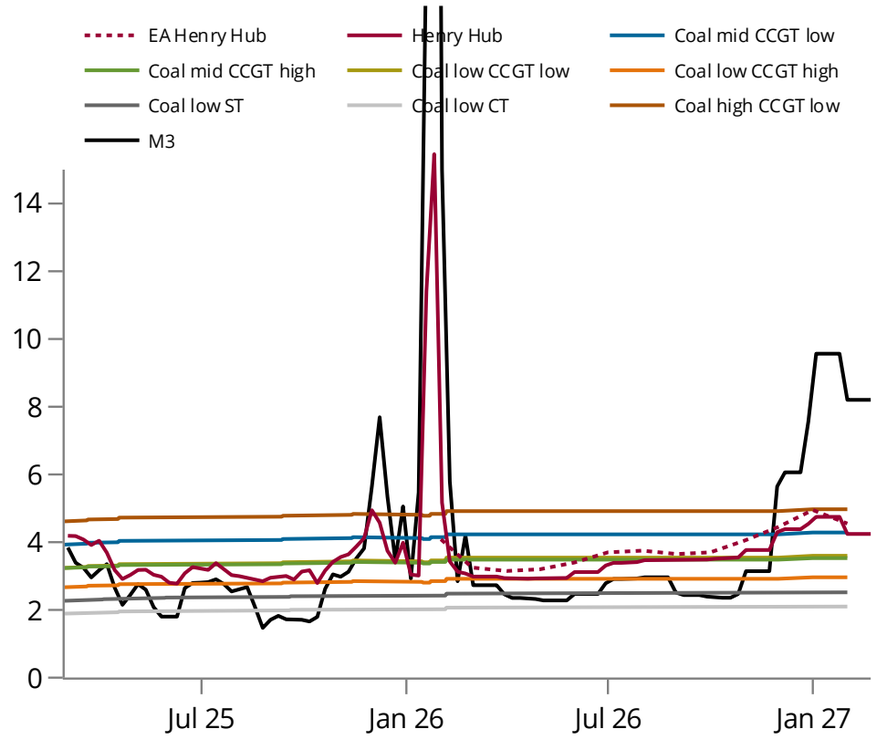
We forecast flat-to-slightly-lower production y/y, as generator inventories will remain near generator target levels at least through summer under normal weather.

Source: Coaldesk, EIA, Energy Aspects

PJM fuel switching, outages

PJM fuel-switching curves

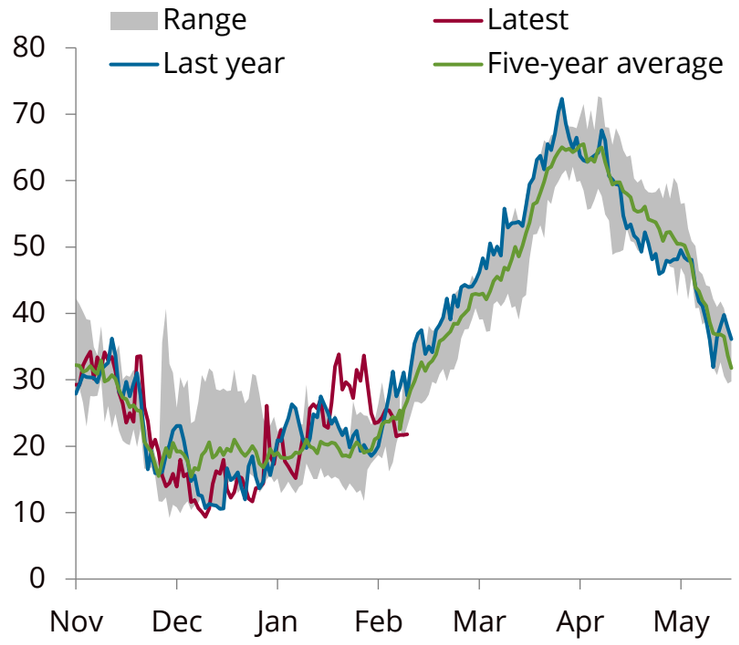
$/MMBtu



M3 forwards currently put most gas in merit against coal this spring, which will moderate coal inventory draws.

PJM generator outages

GW



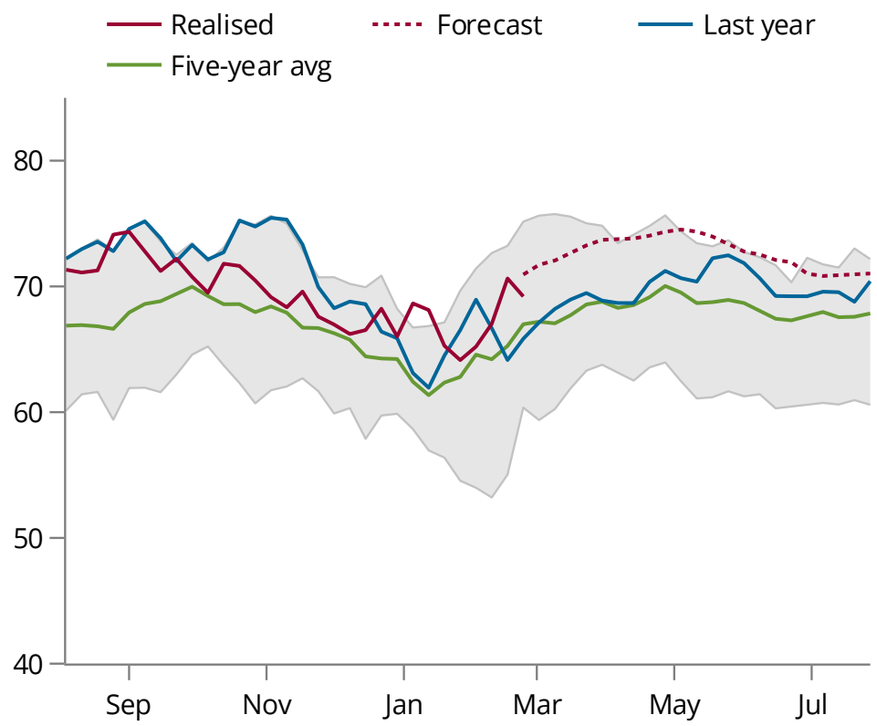
Late-season cold in the east has kept outages from rising into the shoulder season.

Source: ICE, NRC, PJM, Energy Aspects

Gas generation

US gas share of thermal generation

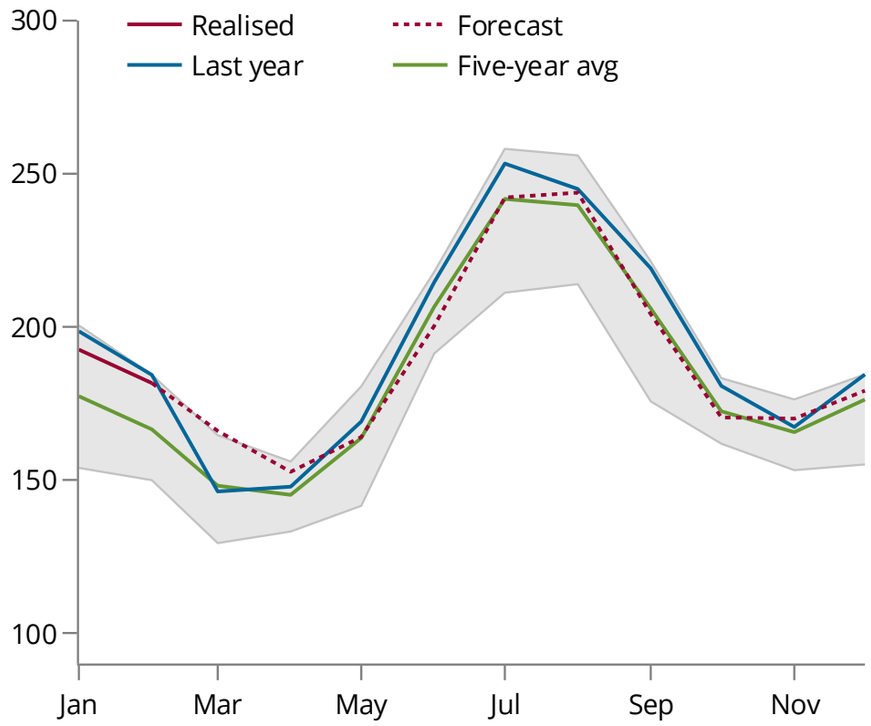
%



Gas share has risen sequentially MTD as colder temperatures moderated. A brief and moderate storm in the Northeast raised coal utilisation.

US gas generation

GW



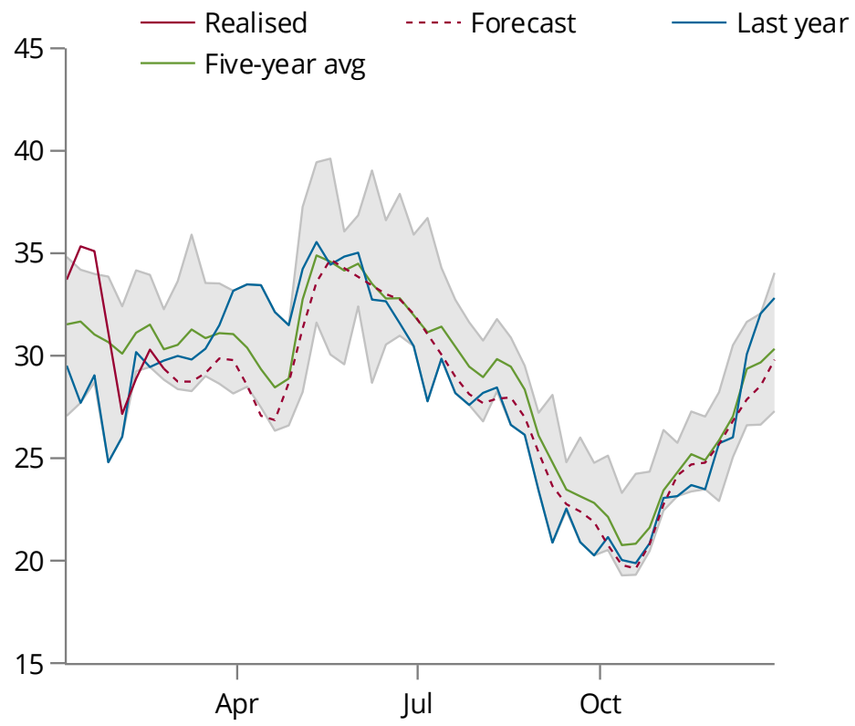
As prompt gas prices continue to decrease, we expect March gas generation to increase by over 3 GW y/y.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

Power generation

US hydro generation

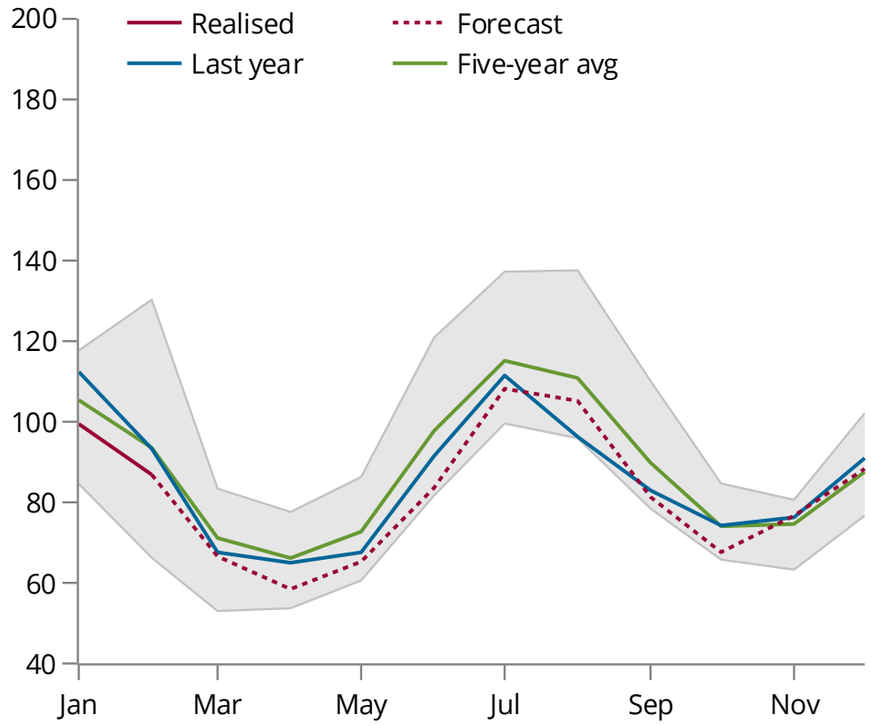
GW



Our hydrological supply index shows waters supplies in large parts of the Eastern Interconnection remain below long-term averages, offset by exceptional rainfall in the US West.

US coal generation

GW



We expect coal generation to realise lower, 0.5 GW y/y for March, as fixed gas prices fall on moderate weather runs.

Source: EIA, Energy Aspects

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